

MARY GOLDA ROSS

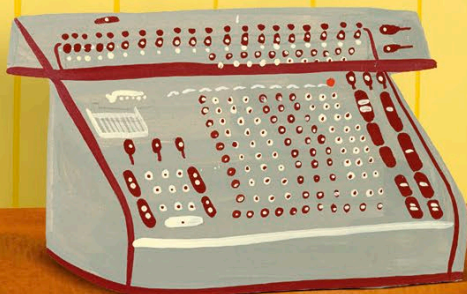
Native American mathematician
and engineer • 1908–2008



*Mary helped
to design
P-38 Lightning
fighter planes.*



*Top-secret Skunk Works projects
were developed in a tent at the
Lockheed base.*



*Mary used an early computer for
her complex mathematics.*

Mary's great-great-grandfather was a famous leader of the Cherokee Nation, a large tribe of Native American people in the United States. The Cherokee believed that girls and boys should be educated equally, but that was not always the case in early 1900s America. Mary often found that she was the only girl in her mathematics and science classes, but she didn't mind.

Mary earned a degree in mathematics and worked as a teacher, before joining the engineering company Lockheed in 1942. Her new employer quickly spotted her extraordinary mathematical ability and sent her to college to train as an aeronautical engineer.

